

SS 2 CITIZENSHIP AND HERITAGE STUDIES WEEKS 1-6

Week: One

Topic: Nigerian Constitution

Step 1: Meaning of the Nigerian Constitution

A constitution is the body of fundamental principles and laws by which a country, state, or organisation is governed. It is regarded as the supreme law of the land because every other law derives its authority from it and must conform to it.

Step 2: Origin of the Nigerian Constitution

Nigeria's constitutional development can be traced through a series of colonial and post-independence constitutions, each building on lessons from the previous one:

Clifford Constitution of 1922 — introduced the elective principle for the first time.

Richards Constitution of 1946 — divided Nigeria into three regions (North, East, West).

Macpherson Constitution of 1951 — introduced a central legislature and greater regional participation.

Lyttleton Constitution of 1954 — established a federal system of government.

Independence Constitution of 1960 — granted Nigeria self-government under a parliamentary system.

Republican Constitution of 1963 — made Nigeria a republic with an indigenous Head of State.

1979 Constitution — introduced the presidential system of government.

1999 Constitution (as amended) — the current constitution, restoring civilian, presidential democracy after military rule.

Step 3: Structure of the 1999 Constitution

The 1999 Constitution is organised into Chapters, Parts, Sections and Schedules for ease of reference and administration.

Chapter I — General Provisions (establishes Nigeria as a Federal Republic and states the supremacy of the Constitution).

Chapter II — Fundamental Objectives and Directive Principles of State Policy.

Chapter III — Citizenship.

Chapter IV — Fundamental Human Rights.

Chapter V — The Legislature (National and State).

Chapter VI — The Executive (Federal and State).

Chapter VII — The Judicature.

Chapter VIII — Federal Capital Territory and General Supplementary Provisions.

Schedules — containing details such as the list of states, local governments, and legislative lists (Exclusive, Concurrent and Residual).

Step 4: Features of the Nigerian Constitution

Supremacy — it is the highest law of the land; every other law is subordinate to it.

Written — it is documented in a single written text.

Rigid — it can only be amended through a special, difficult procedure requiring a high majority in the National and State Assemblies.

Federal character — it recognises Nigeria as a federation of states and provides for power-sharing between the Federal, State, and Local Governments.

Republican — it establishes Nigeria as a republic with an elected President as Head of State and Government.

Provision for Fundamental Human Rights and Fundamental Objectives and Directive Principles of State Policy.

Separation of powers among the Executive, Legislature and Judiciary.

Assignment: In not more than one page, write short notes on any three constitutions Nigeria has had, stating one major feature of each.

Evaluation of Students:

- i. Define the term constitution and explain its meaning in the Nigerian context.
- ii. Trace the historical origin/development of the Nigerian Constitution.
- iii. Describe the structure of the 1999 Constitution.
- iv. State and explain the features of the Nigerian Constitution

Summary: Nigerias constitution is the supreme la that established the structure, powers ,rights, and responsibilities of government and citizens in Nigeria.

Week: Two

Topic: Fundamental Objectives and Directive Principles of State Policy

Instructional Procedure:

Step 1: Meaning

The Fundamental Objectives and Directive Principles of State Policy are the goals and guidelines contained in Chapter II of the 1999 Constitution which direct the government on how to conduct the affairs of the state for the general welfare of the citizens. Although not directly enforceable in a court of law, they serve as a guide to government in law-making, policy formulation and administration.

Step 2: Political Objectives

These aim at building a united, strong and self-reliant nation. They include:

Promotion of national integration and prohibition of discrimination on the grounds of place of origin, sex, religion, status, ethnic or linguistic association.

Encouragement of inter-marriage among persons from different places of origin and the formation of associations that cut across ethnic, linguistic and religious lines.

Ensuring that sovereignty belongs to the people and that government derives its powers and authority from the people.

Guaranteeing participatory democracy and accountability of government to the people.

Step 3: Economic Objectives

These are geared towards a self-reliant and just economic system. They include:

1. Harnessing the resources of the nation to promote national prosperity and an efficient, dynamic and self-reliant economy.
2. Ensuring the material resources of the nation are used to serve the common good.
3. Controlling the national economy to secure the maximum welfare, freedom and happiness of citizens on the basis of social justice and equality.

4. Providing suitable and adequate shelter, food, reasonable minimum wage, old age care, unemployment and sick benefits.

Step 4: Social Objectives

These aim at building a free and democratic society founded on justice and equality. They include:

1. Ensuring that the state's social order is founded on ideals of freedom, equality and justice.
2. Providing adequate medical and health facilities for all persons.
3. Ensuring equal and adequate educational opportunities at all levels.
4. Protecting the family as the basic unit of society and safeguarding the welfare of children, young persons and the aged against exploitation.

iv. Educational Objectives

Education receives special attention as a key tool for national development. Government is directed to:

Direct its policy towards ensuring there are equal and adequate educational opportunities at all levels.

Promote science and technology.

Eradicate illiteracy, and, as far as possible, provide free, compulsory and universal primary education, free secondary and free university education.

Encourage adult education and the education of women and out-of-school youths.

Assignment:

1. List and briefly explain three social objectives of state policy as contained in the 1999 Constitution.

Evaluation of Students:

- i. Explain the meaning of Fundamental Objectives and Directive Principles of State Policy.
- ii. Identify and explain the political objectives of state policy.
- iii. Identify and explain the economic objectives of state policy.
- iv. Identify and explain the social and educational objectives of state policy.

Summary: The fundamental objectives and directive principles of state policy are guidelines in the Nigerian constitution that direct the government to promote good governance, justice, equality, security, and the welfare of citizens.

Week: Three (3)

Topic: Separation of Power

Instructional Procedure:

Step 1: Meaning of Separation of Power

Separation of power is the division of government responsibilities into distinct branches to limit any one branch from exercising the core functions of another. It was propounded by the French philosopher Baron de Montesquieu, who argued that liberty is best protected when the legislative, executive and judicial powers are vested in different, independent bodies.

Step 2: The Executive

The Executive arm is responsible for implementing and enforcing the laws made by the legislature. At the federal level, it is headed by the President, assisted by the Vice President and Ministers; at the state level, by the Governor and Commissioners.

Implements government policies and laws.

Maintains law, order and defence of the country.

Conducts foreign affairs and appoints public officials.

Step 3: The Legislature

The Legislature is the law-making arm of government. At the federal level it is the National Assembly, made up of the Senate and the House of Representatives; at the state level it is the House of Assembly.

Makes laws for the peace, order and good government of the country.

Approves the national/state budget.

Oversees and checks the activities of the Executive through committees and public hearings.

Step 4: . The Judiciary

The Judiciary interprets the laws and administers justice. It comprises the Supreme Court, Court of Appeal, Federal and State High Courts, and other courts established by law.

Interprets the Constitution and other laws.

Settles disputes between individuals, and between individuals and government.

Protects the rights of citizens and ensures justice is administered fairly. . Checks and Balances

- Checks and balances: refer to mechanisms that allow each arm of government to limit or supervise the powers of the other arms, preventing any single arm from becoming too powerful.

The Legislature can override a presidential veto and can impeach the President or Governor.

The Executive can veto (decline to assent to) bills passed by the Legislature.

The Judiciary can declare laws made by the Legislature or actions of the Executive unconstitutional (judicial review).

The Legislature confirms certain executive appointments (e.g., Ministers, judges)

Assignment: Draw and label a simple diagram showing the three arms of government and write one way each arm checks the powers of another.

Evaluation of Students:

- i. Explain the meaning and purpose of separation of power.
- ii. Identify the three arms of government and their functions.
- iii. Explain the concept of checks and balances.
- iv. State the importance of separation of power in preventing abuse of authority.

Summary: Separation of powers is the division of government powers among the legislature, executive and judiciary to prevent abuse of power.

Week: Four (4)

Topic: Public Service and Citizenship

Step 1: Meaning of Public Service and Citizenship

Public service refers to the body of government employees (civil servants) who are engaged in the administration and implementation of government policies and programmes in ministries, departments and agencies. Citizenship refers to the status of being a recognised member of a state, which confers rights and imposes duties and responsibilities on the individual towards the state.

Step 2: . Role of the Civil Service

- 1. Implementing government policies, programmes and decisions.**
2. Providing continuity and stability in administration regardless of changes in political leadership.
3. Advising government ministers/commissioners on policy matters based on technical expertise.
4. Delivering essential public services such as education, health, security and infrastructure.
5. Maintaining official records and ensuring efficient administration of government business.

Step 3: Duties of Citizens

Just as citizens enjoy rights, the Constitution and civic responsibility require citizens to fulfil certain duties, including:

1. Obeying the laws of the land and respecting the rights of others.
2. Paying taxes promptly and honestly.
3. Participating in the democratic process, including voting during elections.
4. Protecting public property and the environment.
5. Rendering support to law enforcement agencies and cooperating with public servants performing lawful duties.
6. Contributing positively to national development and unity.

Step 4: . Challenges Facing Public Service

1. Corruption and misappropriation of public funds.
2. Bureaucratic bottlenecks and delays in service delivery (red-tapism).
3. Inadequate funding, tools and infrastructure for effective service delivery.
4. Poor remuneration and welfare of public servants, leading to low morale.
5. Political interference and lack of continuity when governments change.
6. Inadequate training and manpower development for civil servants.

Assignment: Interview a civil servant in your community (or

Evaluation of Students:

- i. Explain the meaning of public/civil service and citizenship.
- ii. Describe the roles of the civil service in national development.
- i. State the duties of citizens towards the public service and the nation.
- ii. Identify the challenges facing public service delivery in Nigeria.

Summary: Citizenship education teaches people how to be responsible, active and respectful members of society/nation

Week: Five (5)

Topic: Nigerian Heritage Sites

Sub-Topics: UNESCO sites, National museums, Parks

Step 1: . UNESCO World Heritage Sites in Nigeria

A heritage site is a place recognised for its cultural, historical, scientific or natural significance and legally protected for the benefit of present and future generations. UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) maintains a World Heritage List of sites of outstanding universal value. Nigeria has two sites on this list:

Sukur Cultural Landscape (Adamawa State) — inscribed in 1999; features the Palace of the Hidi (traditional ruler), terraced fields, and evidence of a once-flourishing iron-smelting industry.

Osun-Osogbo Sacred Grove (Osun State) — inscribed in 2005; a dense forest along the banks of the Osun River, regarded as the abode of the river goddess Osun, and one of the last remaining sacred groves that used to be common in Yoruba culture.

Step 2: National Museums

National museums are government-established institutions responsible for collecting, preserving, studying and displaying objects of historical, cultural and artistic importance.

National Museum, Lagos — houses the famous Nok terracotta figures and Benin bronzes.

National Museum, Jos — one of the oldest, established in 1952, known for its ceramics and pottery collections.

National Museum, Benin City — preserves artefacts of the ancient Benin Kingdom, including bronze and ivory works.

National Museum, Kaduna — houses ethnographic materials representing Northern Nigerian cultures.

Functions: preservation of artefacts, research and education, promotion of tourism, and strengthening of national identity and pride.

Step 3: National Parks

National parks are protected natural areas set aside by government to conserve wildlife, plants and natural landscapes for ecological balance, research, education and tourism.

Yankari National Park (Bauchi State) — known for elephants, warm springs and diverse wildlife.

Cross River National Park (Cross River State) — home to rich tropical rainforest and endangered species such as gorillas.

Kainji Lake National Park (Niger/Kwara States) — Nigeria's first national park, established around Kainji Lake.

Gashaka-Gumti National Park (Taraba/Adamawa States) — the largest national park in Nigeria, noted for chimpanzees and mountainous terrain.

Assignment: Write short notes on any one Nigerian UNESCO World Heritage Site, one national museum, and one national park, stating one interesting fact about each.

Evaluation of Students:

- i. Explain the meaning of heritage sites.
- ii. Identify Nigerian sites recognised by UNESCO as World Heritage Sites.
- iii. Describe the roles of national museums in preserving Nigerian heritage.
- iv. Identify major national parks in Nigeria and explain their significance.

Summary: A heritage site is a place of historical cultural, or natural importance that is preserved for future generations

Week: Six (6)

Topic: Traditional Institutions

Sub-Topics: Roles of Chiefs, Kings, Emirs, Obas, Obis

Step 1: Meaning of Traditional Institutions

Traditional institutions refer to indigenous systems of authority and governance headed by traditional rulers who derive their positions through inheritance, custom or communal selection, rather than through modern electoral processes. They have existed in Nigeria since pre-colonial times and remain custodians of culture and tradition.

Step 2: Types of Traditional Rulers in Nigeria

1. Emirs — traditional rulers found mainly among the Hausa-Fulani in Northern Nigeria (e.g., the Emir of Kano, Emir of Katsina).
2. Obas — traditional rulers among the Yoruba people in South-Western Nigeria (e.g., the Oba of Benin, Ooni of Ife, Alaafin of Oyo).
3. Obis — traditional rulers among the Igbo people in South-Eastern Nigeria (e.g., the Obi of Onitsha).
4. Chiefs — a general title for traditional rulers or title holders found across many ethnic groups, including the Niger Delta and Middle Belt regions.

Step 3: Roles of Traditional Rulers

1. Custodians of culture — preserving and promoting the customs, traditions and values of their people.
2. Maintenance of peace and order — settling disputes and conflicts within their domain through traditional councils.
3. Advisory role — advising government on matters affecting their communities, including security and development.

4. Mobilisation of the people — rallying communities for developmental projects, government programmes, and social causes (e.g., immunisation campaigns, census).
5. Symbol of unity — serving as a unifying figure who commands loyalty and respect across the community regardless of political affiliation.
6. Religious and ceremonial functions — presiding over cultural festivals, rites of passage, and traditional ceremonies.

Assignment: Write a short paragraph describing the traditional ruler of your local community or state, including his title and one role he performs.

Evaluation of Students:

1. Explain the meaning of traditional institutions.
2. Identify types of traditional rulers found in different parts of Nigeria.
3. Describe the roles of chiefs, kings, emirs, obas and obis in society.

Summary: Traditional institutions are established customs, systems, and authorities passed down from one generation to another that helps govern and guide a community.